Ian Laird

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Seattle, Washington

Software engineer with 6 years of experience scaling distributed systems at Google and Capital One. Specializes in launching latency-sensitive and high-throughput GenAI integrations.

Google - GCP

2022 - Present

Software Engineer III Sensitive Data Protection — Promoted 2023
Software Engineer II

- Led three urgent DeepMind integrations that unblocked global launches, all delivered ahead of schedule. Designed the evaluation method used to compare candidate models on cost, quality, and latency.
- Led the Vertex AI integration enabling client-supplied LLM prompts for detection, improving precision and offering customers more flexibility in filtering criteria.
- Designed and launched a new conversational API for multi-turn ingestion featuring various content types. Onboarded multiple GenAI teams to solve urgent customer escalations.
- Shipped 10 new data-scanning categories over four quarters of cross-team work, eliminating manual configuration and improving default detection coverage for customers.
- Achieved a 50% latency reduction and 40% F1 improvement over a legacy NER solution by designing and launching a multilingual purpose-built NER model using TensorFlow and BERT.
- On-call owner for a GCP service handling tens of millions of queries per minute globally. Led the cross-team postmortem on two major outages, aligning multiple teams on root cause and remediation.
- Identified gaps in security controls for GenAI training data and led remediation across a 30-person org, unblocking a high-priority product integration; separately drove a multi-quarter hardening effort across four production servers with zero downtime.

Capital One

2020 - 2022

Senior Associate Software Engineer Small Business Lending — Promoted 2021
Associate Software Engineer Automotive Lending

- Reduced operating costs by $500K+ and saved 2,000+ developer hours annually by unblocking the decommissioning of a legacy COBOL mainframe. Replaced it with a Spark-on-EMR data pipeline, orchestrated by a containerized Java microservice, processing large datasets from S3 and Snowflake.
- Retired a second legacy mainframe by building an Angular and Spring Boot application for financial fraud tracking under a CEO-level initiative to decommission all mainframes. This application was used by every automotive finance fraud investigator across the company.
- Led cloud resiliency and compliance initiatives including multi-region failover infrastructure and cross-system data migration, reducing the service's failover time from hours to minutes during regional failure events.

Projects ianclaird.com

- 4 player multiplayer co-op game with deterministic lockstep netplay, seeded RNG simulation, and mid-run reconnection.
- Claude-driven game featuring multi-layered abuse prevention and server-authoritative state via Lambda and DynamoDB.
- A2P text and phone interactions hosted by Twilio featuring an elevenlabs generated AI voice.

Languages

Java
C / C++
Python
SQL
JavaScript / TypeScript

Cloud & Infra

AWS (S3, EC2, RDS, ECS, EMR, IAM)
GCP (Spanner, BQ, SDP)
Container Orchestration
CI/CD pipelines
Distributed Build Systems
Vertex AI

Tools

TensorFlow
BERT
Spring Boot
Apache Spark
gRPC
Anthropic API
Twilio
ElevenLabs

Education

Baylor University
BSCS - 2020
Magna Cum Laude